

JAGGAER CONTENT BRIEF

Government Contract Leakage: 5 Numbers France, Spain & UK Cannot Ignore in 2026

TOFU · Geography: EU · Target word count: 1,600–2,000 words · Primary ranking opportunity: government contract leakage data 2026 (KD n/a — no keyword export supplied or located)

Brief at a glance

URL SLUG	/government-contract-leakage-data-2026
CONTENT TYPE	Data Snapshot — E-Invoicing & AP Automation cluster anchor. No spoke exists yet in this cluster, so there is no sibling piece to link to or from yet.
TARGET WORD COUNT	1,600–2,000 words — the “5 Numbers” title format commits the piece to five stat-led sections rather than narrative prose.
TARGET AUDIENCE	Public-sector finance, procurement, and AP leaders in France, Spain, and the UK who suspect off-contract spend is a problem but haven't seen it quantified per country. TOFU.
FUNNEL / GEO / PATH	TOFU · Geography: EU · Publishing Week 2 (per project card)
PRIMARY KEYWORD	government contract leakage data 2026 — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. No keyword export was supplied or could be located (see Section 2). Drives H1/title/framing only.
SECONDARY KEYWORDS	off-contract spend public sector UK France Spain — stakeholder-specified, kept exactly as given. Same caveat: no keyword data available.
PILLAR PAGE LINK	No Public Sector pillar page exists yet. As the cluster anchor, this piece has no existing spoke to link down to — see Section 5.
PUBLISH PRIORITY	High — cluster anchor and the first piece in a new pillar (Public Sector). The underlying data (2024 EU Single Market Scoreboard, a Feb 2026 Spanish Tribunal de Cuentas report, current UK NAO findings) is current but time-sensitive.

1. Search intent analysis

The reader is a public-sector finance or procurement leader — in central government, a local authority, or a public body — who has heard “contract leakage” or “off-contract spend” used as a warning sign, but hasn't seen it quantified for their own market. TOFU, but data-hungry TOFU: they want current, country-specific numbers, not a generic definition they've already encountered elsewhere.

What the reader needs to leave with

- Current numbers for all three markets: how much of France's, Spain's, and the UK's public spend bypasses competitive, contracted procedures, and how each compares to its European peers.
- Why the mechanism differs by country: France and Spain measure this via court-of-auditors findings on “hors marché” / “contratos menores” spend; the UK's leakage shows up in cost overruns and under-tracked contractor spend.
- That this isn't a fringe problem — audit bodies flag it repeatedly across all three markets.
- A next step: how AP automation and e-invoicing create the visibility that catches off-contract spend before an audit does.

SERP features to target

Featured snippet — a single sentence stating that off-contract and off-tender spend is a measurable, audited problem across all three markets, directly under the H1.

People Also Ask — FAQ section (Section 6) reframed around “how is this measured” and “is this getting better or worse” rather than generic procurement-fraud definitions.

Competitive intent note: none of the ten supplied SERP links deliver current, country-specific leakage data for France, Spain, and the UK together. The strongest (Britain Remade) measures infrastructure build-cost premiums, not contract leakage; three cover US federal FCA/FAR enforcement; two cover post-Brexit UK/EU market access; one is a US ERP vendor blog; one covers Australian local government; the FT link was site-blocked. No supplied link served as a usable primary source — see Section 8.

STAKEHOLDER NOTE

Primary/secondary keywords and the topic are stakeholder-set and kept exactly as given, per explicit instruction. No keyword export was supplied or located (see Section 2). The ten supplied SERP links were reviewed directly; none supported this piece's claim, so every figure in Section 8 was sourced independently from primary government and EU sources.

2. Target keywords

Primary

KEYWORD	MSV	KD	INTENT
government contract leakage data 2026	—	—	Stakeholder-set primary — drives H1/title/framing, unchanged
off-contract spend public sector UK France Spain	—	—	Stakeholder-set secondary — kept as-is, unchanged

Secondary — capture via subheadings and FAQ

No keyword export was supplied or located for this brief. Rather than inventing supporting keywords, volumes, or difficulty scores, this section is limited to directional recommendations: a dedicated pull on terms such as “off-contract spend public sector,” “public procurement single bidder rate,” “contrato menor fraccionamiento,” “achats hors marché collectivité,” “government contractor spend UK,” and “public sector maverick spend.”

Ultra-low KD callout: not applicable — no KD data exists for this brief to flag against.

No corrections were made to the stakeholder-supplied primary/secondary keywords; no additional anchor terms were added.

3. Recommended page structure

ELEMENT	CONTENT GUIDANCE
H1 (Title)	Government Contract Leakage: 5 Numbers France, Spain & UK Cannot Ignore in 2026 (kept exactly as specified)
Meta title	Contract Leakage: 5 Numbers for 2026 — 52 characters
Meta description	See the real 2026 data on public-sector contract leakage and off-contract spend across France, Spain, and the UK. — 116 characters
Intro (100-150 words)	Snippet-ready: state plainly this is a five-number data snapshot, not a general definition piece. Lead with the starkest number — Spain's 33% single-bidder rate or the 78% audit-flagged minor-contract finding — to earn the featured snippet.
H2: Number 1 — Spain's Single-Bidder Problem	33% of Spanish public tenders drew only one bid in 2024 — above the 28% EU average (European Commission, Single Market Scoreboard). Primary visual (Section 4) goes here.
H2: Number 2 — Spain's Audited “Contratos Menores”	78% of a national sample of Spanish minor/direct-award contracts (260 files, 2024, €3.8m) lacked justification for bypassing competitive tender (Tribunal de Cuentas, Feb 2026).
H2: Number 3 — France's “Hors Marché” Spend	Regional courts of auditors (CRC Île-de-France) found off-contract purchasing as high as 23-31% at individual public bodies, against a “rigorous management” benchmark of under 10%.
H2: Number 4 — The UK's Digital and Contractor Spend Gap	UK NAO: digital/technology programme cost overruns up to £3bn against ~£14bn annual digital spend; contractors are ~18% of headcount but 40% of staffing costs. Secondary visual goes here.
H2: Number 5 — The Transparency Gap Behind the Leakage	Spain publishes only 3.2% of GDP in contract value on TED, versus 6.1% for France and a 5.8% EU average.
H2: Why This Keeps Happening	Tie the numbers to a lack of transaction-level visibility into whether spend flows through contracted terms. Flag for sign-off before naming any JAGGAER capability.
H2: FAQ	8 questions — see Section 6.
H2: Next steps	Link to the Public Sector pillar page once it exists, and to a spend-visibility demo CTA (Section 5).

4. Visual production notes

Primary visual

A five-tile stat grid, one tile per number: 33% Spain's single-bidder rate, 2024 (EU avg 28%) · 78% Spanish minor-contract sample flagged for weak justification (Tribunal de Cuentas, 2026) · 23-31% France's "hors marché" spend (CRC benchmark: under 10%) · £3bn UK digital/tech cost overruns vs. ~£14bn annual spend (NAO) · 3.2% share of Spain's GDP in contract value published on TED (EU avg 5.8%). Appears within the first two scrolls.

Secondary visual (if applicable)

A three-row country comparison table — France, Spain, UK — each showing its primary leakage mechanism, headline number, and source. Appears under "Why This Keeps Happening."

Formatting notes: keep tables to 3-5 columns. Cite each figure's source directly beside it rather than in a footnote.

SIGN-OFF NEEDED

Do not name a specific JAGGAER capability without product marketing confirmation. Have legal and product marketing confirm this piece reads as a factual, country-neutral data snapshot rather than a claim about any one country's public administration before publish.

5. Internal linking plan

DESTINATION	ANCHOR TEXT	PLACEMENT
Pillar page — Public Sector	Does not exist yet — TBC. First piece in a new pillar.	Intro; Next steps
Product / CTA — JAGGAER e-invoicing & AP automation	"the visibility that catches off-contract spend before an audit does" (TBC pending confirmation)	Why This Keeps Happening; Next steps
External — EC Single Market Scoreboard (France & Spain)	"the European Commission's own procurement data"	Numbers 1 and 5
External — Tribunal de Cuentas minor-contract report	"a February 2026 national audit"	Number 2
External — UK National Audit Office	"the UK's National Audit Office"	Number 4

As the cluster anchor and the first piece in the Public Sector pillar, this piece should accumulate inbound links as the E-Invoicing & AP Automation cluster grows — revisit this table once a spoke is built.

6. FAQ targets

Each answer should be 2-3 sentences, written to target the PAA box. Answers must be self-contained — assume the reader may read only the FAQ.

- What counts as “contract leakage” in public-sector procurement?
- How much public spend actually happens outside a formal contract?
- Why does Spain have such a high single-bidder rate in public tenders?
- What are “contratos menores” and why does Spain's Tribunal de Cuentas flag them?
- What does “hors marché” spend mean in French public procurement audits?
- Is off-contract spend the same as fraud?
- Why does the UK's leakage problem look different from France's or Spain's?
- Is public procurement transparency getting better or worse across the EU?

7. SEO and technical requirements

URL	/government-contract-leakage-data-2026 (no date beyond the year — treat as a snapshot piece, not fully evergreen)
Title tag	Contract Leakage: 5 Numbers for 2026 — 52 characters
Meta description	See the real 2026 data on public-sector contract leakage and off-contract spend across France, Spain, and the UK. — 116 characters
Schema markup	Article + FAQPage schema on the FAQ section. Consider Dataset markup for the stat grid, since the page's core value is the underlying data points.
Update cadence	High — review when the European Commission publishes its next annual Single Market Scoreboard, when a new Tribunal de Cuentas or Cour des comptes / CRC report is released, or when the UK NAO publishes new findings.
Canonical	Self-canonical. Plan for a full data refresh once the 2025 Single Market Scoreboard cycle publishes.
Disclaimer	Recommended: note that figures are sourced from national audit bodies and the European Commission at specific points in time and may not be directly comparable across countries.

8. Recommended sources

List only primary sources: official documentation, regulatory text, government publications, peer-reviewed research, or official organization guidance.

- European Commission, Single Market and Competitiveness Scoreboard — “Access to public procurement,” France and Spain pages, 2024 data (fetched and verified directly) — single-bidder rate, no-calls-for-bids rate, and TED publication-rate figures.
- Tribunal de Cuentas (Spain) — report on excessive/unjustified use of minor contracts in Área de gasto 2, ~27 February 2026 (fetched and verified directly) — the 78% finding.
- Chambre régionale des comptes, Île-de-France — findings on “achats hors marché,” via achat-logistique.info (verified directly; source the underlying CRC reports directly before publication) — France's off-contract spend figures.
- UK National Audit Office — reports on external consultants (Nov 2025) and digital/technology programme delivery (fetched and verified directly, one figure cross-checked via The Register) — UK cost-overrun and contractor-cost figures.
- UK Parliament, Science, Innovation and Technology Committee — contractor headcount/staffing-cost share findings — verify directly against the Committee's own report before citing.

Source note: all ten supplied SERP links were fetched and reviewed directly; none provided usable primary data for this piece's claim — see Section 1. The Financial Times article was site-blocked and could not be reviewed. All data used here was located independently through primary government and EU sources, not the supplied set.

This brief was generated with no MSV keyword data, as none was supplied or could be located (see Section 2). This document is not legal, financial, or audit advice.